

Question 47 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the relationship among Training Needs Assessment, training design, training delivery, and training evaluation.

Introduction

These four are the stages of the training cycle in the notes. They are not four optional activities. They are one process of planned learning, which matches Nadler's idea of organised learning for behavioural change. The relationship is both a straight line (each stage feeds the next) and a circle (evaluation feeds the next TNA). If any link is broken, training becomes an event rather than HRD.

Detailed points

- 1. TNA feeds design.** Organisation, task and person analysis tell design what the goal is, who is in the room, what content and method fit, and what constraints exist. Design without TNA is a decorated guess, often an off-the-shelf programme the notes warn against.
- 2. Design feeds delivery.** The plan — sequence, methods, facilities, trainer brief, transfer tasks, tests — is what implementers carry out. Delivery without design is improvisation (sometimes talented, usually uneven). Design without delivery is a document in a drawer.
- 3. Delivery feeds evaluation.** You evaluate what was actually delivered, not what was hoped. Tests, observations and later job data come from the real programme. If delivery skipped practice, evaluation will (honestly) show weak skill — which is useful information.
- 4. Evaluation feeds the next TNA.** Remaining gaps, new errors, and wrong earlier diagnoses become the next need analysis. Training in HRD is continuous, not a one-shot. Evaluation also tells whether the original 'need' was not a training need at all.
- 5. Evaluation feeds redesign of design and delivery.** Poor learning → change content or method. Poor reaction → trainer or admin. Poor behaviour → transfer climate and boss support, not only prettier slides. This is how the cycle improves quality.
- 6. If TNA is skipped, the chain is poisoned.** Design aims at the wrong target; delivery may be excellent for the wrong thing; evaluation cannot define success. Many 'failed' programmes failed at Stage 1, not at the trainer.
- 7. If evaluation is skipped, the loop is open.** The organisation never learns whether delivery was worth it. Next year's TNA is again guesswork. HRD cannot claim professional or strategic status.
- 8. Picture to remember for the exam.** Draw in words: TNA → Design → Delivery → Evaluation → back to TNA. Write one sentence on each arrow. Add: all four must be budgeted, not only the visible classroom day.

Conclusion. *TNA, design, delivery and evaluation are sequential and circular stages of one training cycle. Each provides input to the next, and evaluation renews TNA and improves design/delivery. Breaking any link reduces training to an isolated event and weakens HRD.*